

How is Active Directory structured?

The structure of Active Directory is based on a hierarchical, tree-like model. The top of the hierarchy is the forest, which is the highest level of organization in an Active Directory environment. The forest contains one or more domains, and each domain can contain multiple organizational units (OUs).

The components of the Active Directory structure are:

1. **Forest:** The highest level of organization in an Active Directory environment. A forest can contain multiple domains.
2. **Domain:** A collection of network resources, such as computers and users, that are administered as a unit with common rules and procedures. Each domain has a unique name, and the name of each domain is separated by a dot (e.g., example.com).
3. **Organizational Unit (OU):** A container object within a domain that can be used to organize and manage resources, such as user accounts, computers, and other objects. OUs can be nested within other OUs to create a hierarchical structure.
4. **Objects:** The resources in the directory, such as user accounts, computers, groups, and printers. Each object has attributes that define its properties, such as name, address, and security settings.

Active Directory also uses a hierarchical namespace, which provides a logical structure for organizing and accessing resources. The namespace is based on the domain structure, and the fully qualified domain name (FQDN) of an object is used to identify its location within the namespace.

In summary, the structure of Active Directory is a hierarchical, tree-like model that consists of forests, domains, OUs, and objects. The hierarchical structure enables administrators to organize and manage resources more efficiently, and the namespace provides a logical structure for accessing those resources.